

DWARVES OF THE EXTREMES



WE PRESENT THREE NEW DWARVEN TYPES. Ice Dwarves, Volcanic Dwarves, and Dark Dwarves.

Dwarves of the Extremes is a monster supplement for 5e that presents dwarves not as generic mountain craftsmen, but as civilizations hardened by the most unforgiving environments in the world. Instead of relying on a single dwarf stat block, this book provides three distinct and escalating NPC ladders: glacier-bound fortress dwellers, magma-forged industrial theocrats, and authoritarian subterranean regimes.

These are not alternate ancestries. They are alternate adaptations.

The intent of this product is environmental pressure and cultural divergence. Ice dwarves represent endurance, communal discipline, and survival against a world locked in frost. Volcanic dwarves represent transformation through fire, sacred industry, and societies built around living flame. Dark dwarves represent rigid hierarchy, subterranean control, and the belief that order must be enforced as unyieldingly as stone itself. Each ladder escalates not simply in strength, but in authority, responsibility, and cultural weight.

Geography, alliances, and rivalries are intentionally undefined. These NPCs can represent polar citadels carved from living glacier, caldera empires suspended above rivers of magma, or deep-stone dominions that have not seen the sun in generations. They are not meant to replace traditional dwarves—they are branches of the same ancestral stock, shaped by different extremes of climate, pressure, and philosophy.

Whether these cultures trade, feud, wage elemental wars, or consider surface dwarves softened by comfort is left entirely in the GM's hands.

ICE DWARVES

"STONE REMEMBERS. ICE PRESERVES."

Ice dwarves endure where others freeze. Their holds are carved into glaciers, permafrost cliffs, and wind-scoured mountain faces. Every structure is reinforced against collapse, every patrol trained for whiteout conditions, and every citizen taught that survival depends on cohesion.

They are patient, disciplined, and pragmatic. Retreat is not cowardice—it is preservation. Defense is not glory—it is necessity. Their society values stability above conquest, and every rung of their ladder reflects responsibility to the hold.

Ice dwarves are designed for:

- High-altitude or tundra strongholds
- Defensive sieges in hazardous terrain

- Expeditionary encounters in frozen wilderness
- Fortress politics defined by resource scarcity

They do not seek warmth. They build permanence in cold.

VOLCANIC DWARVES

"THROUGH FIRE, WE ARE REFINED."

Volcanic dwarves live in the shadow of eruption. Their cities cling to caldera walls, span lava rivers, and pulse with the rhythm of immense forges. Heat is not merely endured—it is revered. Industry is sacred. Flame is transformation.

Their culture prizes productivity, strength, and visible contribution. The forge is both altar and factory, and leadership is measured by what one shapes—steel, stone, or society. Each step in their ladder reflects increasing mastery over heat, labor, and authority.

Volcanic dwarves are designed for:

- Industrial fortress-cities
- Magma-lit dungeon environments
- Fire-driven battlefield hazards
- Religious or ideological conflicts centered on craft

They do not fear destruction. They harness it.

DARK DWARVES

"STONE DOES NOT BEND."

Dark dwarves dwell in the deepest reaches of the earth, where light is rare and order is absolute. Their halls are geometric, efficient, and silent. Emotion is weakness. Disorder is threat. Authority is structural.

They are not chaotic marauders. They are organized regimes. Labor is mandatory. Discipline is enforced. Loyalty is expected. Their ladder reflects increasing control—over tunnels, over forges, over people.

Dark dwarves are designed for:

- Oppressive subterranean empires
- Chokepoint-heavy dungeon warfare
- Authoritarian societies in moral conflict
- Structured, formation-based combat encounters

They do not rage. They impose.

Dwarves of the Extremes offers three philosophies shaped by environment: endurance, transformation, and control. How these cultures interact—whether as rivals, distant cousins, or ideological enemies—remains entirely in the GM's hands.

ICE DWARVES

Name	Challenge Rating	Description
Ice Dwarf Commoner	0	Artisan, hunter, fisher, or ice-farmer who sustains the hold through survival skill rather than martial training.
Ice Dwarf Snow Scout	1/8	Lightly armed pathfinder skilled in snow camouflage and navigating frozen terrain.
Ice Dwarf Frost Sentry	1/4	Defensive guard stationed along ice bridges and glacier passes, trained to hold narrow approaches.
Ice Dwarf Avalanche Skirmisher	1/2	Mobile warrior who exploits unstable snow and shifting ice to disrupt advancing enemies.
Ice Dwarf Adept	1	Runic frost spellcaster who channels ancestral glacier lore to slow enemies and reinforce disciplined formation defense.
Ice Dwarf Frostwarden	3	Veteran leader responsible for securing glacier tunnels and coordinating counterattacks in harsh weather.
Ice Dwarf Mage	5	Senior rune spellcaster of the glacier holds who commands battlefield frost, reshaping terrain and locking enemies in disciplined cold control.
Ice Dwarf Whitehold Jarl	7	Ruler of a high glacier citadel, blending martial authority and ancestral rune tradition.
Ice Dwarf High Runefather	9	Supreme leader of the ice holds, master of frost-forged relics and glacier-bound wards.

VOLCANIC DWARVES

Name	Challenge Rating	Description
Volcanic Dwarf Commoner	0	Smith, ash-farmer, or forge laborer who sustains the caldera hold through disciplined craft.
Volcanic Dwarf Ash Runner	1/8	Swift messenger and scout accustomed to smoke-choked tunnels and unstable stone.
Volcanic Dwarf Emberguard	1/4	Frontline defender trained to secure lava bridges and protect forge entrances.
Volcanic Dwarf Cinder Skirmisher	1/2	Aggressive combatant who uses sparks, ash, and shifting footing to pressure enemies.
Volcanic Dwarf Magma Adept	1	Fire-focused forge spellcaster who channels controlled magma and disciplined flamecraft to shape the battlefield.
Volcanic Dwarf Caldera Captain	3	Tactical leader who commands formations amid smoke and flame.
Volcanic Dwarf Forgebinder	5	Master artisan-warrior who shapes both weapons and battlefield hazards through living flame.
Volcanic Dwarf Flame Mage	7	Senior battlefield spellcaster responsible for directing controlled eruptions and coordinated fire assaults within the volcanic holds.
Volcanic Dwarf Inferno King	9	Supreme ruler of the volcanic holds, embodiment of relentless heat and industrial might.

DARK DWARVES

Name	Challenge Rating	Description
Dark Dwarf Commoner	0	Laborer, mason, or smith who sustains the subterranean hold through relentless industry.
Dark Dwarf Tunnel Warden	1/8	Armed sentry trained to fight in tight corridors and prevent intrusion.
Dark Dwarf Basalt Guard	1/4	Heavily armored defender drilled to hold choke points without retreat.
Dark Dwarf Iron Enforcer	1/2	Authority figure tasked with suppressing dissent and maintaining order through force.
Dark Dwarf Shield Captain	1	Tactical leader who coordinates disciplined formations and punishes disorder.
Dark Dwarf Stone Inquisitor	3	Investigator who roots out weakness, rebellion, and heresy within the hold.
Dark Dwarf Obsidian Marshal	5	Battlefield commander who directs formations with cold precision.
Dark Dwarf High Forgelord	7	Master of the deep forges whose authority shapes both industry and war.
Dark Dwarf Basalt Tyrant	9	Absolute ruler of the dark dominions, embodiment of rigid order and stonebound authority.

ICE DWARF AVALANCHE SKIRMISHER

Medium humanoid (dwarf), any lawful

Armor Class 15 (scale mail)

Hit Points 68 (8d8 + 32)

Speed 25 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	12 (+1)	18 (+4)	10 (+0)	13 (+1)	10 (+0)

Skills Athletics +5, Survival +3, Perception +3

Damage Resistances cold

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 13

Languages Common, Dwarvish

Challenge 1/2 (100 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +2

Ice Walker. The skirmisher ignores difficult terrain caused by ice or snow.

Shifting Ice. When the skirmisher moves at least 10 feet across ice or snow before hitting a creature with a melee attack, the target must succeed on a DC 13 Strength saving throw or be pushed up to 10 feet and knocked prone.

Cracking Ground. When the skirmisher ends its turn, it can cause the ground in a 5-foot radius around it to become unstable ice until the start of its next turn. That area is difficult terrain for creatures other than Ice Dwarves.

ACTIONS:

Multiattack. The skirmisher makes two battleaxe attacks.

Battleaxe. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 8 (1d8 + 3) slashing damage plus 3 (1d6) cold damage.

Snow Slide (Recharge 5–6). The skirmisher kicks loose snow and ice in a 15-foot line that is 5 feet wide. Creatures in the line must make a DC 13 Dexterity saving throw, taking 10 (3d6) bludgeoning damage and falling prone on a failed save, or half as much damage on a success.

- Uses forced movement and prone effects to break formations.
- Targets lightly armored or mobile enemies first.
- Exploits unstable terrain aggressively.
- Avoids extended melee without support.



VOLCANIC DWARF FLAME MAGE

Medium humanoid (dwarf), any lawful

Armor Class 15 (half plate)

Hit Points 168 (16d8 + 96)

Speed 25 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	10 (+0)	22 (+6)	16 (+3)	18 (+4)	14 (+2)

Saving Throws Con +9, Wis +7, Int +6

Skills Arcana +6, Religion +6, Perception +7

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 17

Damage Resistances fire

Languages Common, Dwarvish

Challenge 7 (2,900 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +3

Children of the Caldera. This dwarf has resistance to fire damage and ignores difficult terrain caused by ash, cinders, or heated stone.

Aura of Searing Doctrine. A 10-foot radius around this dwarf shimmers with intense heat. Enemy creatures that start their turn in the aura take 5 (1d10) fire damage.

Forge Mastery. When this dwarf casts a spell that deals fire damage, it can choose one creature affected by the spell. That creature's speed is reduced by 10 feet until the end of its next turn.

Tempered Mind. This dwarf has advantage on saving throws against being charmed or frightened.

Spellcasting. This dwarf is a 9th-level spellcaster. Its spellcasting ability is Wisdom (spell save DC 15, +7 to hit with spell attacks). This dwarf requires no material components for spells that deal fire damage.

- **Cantrips (at will):** fire bolt
- **1st level (4 slots):** burning hands, searing smite, shield of faith
- **2nd level (3 slots):** scorching ray, heat metal
- **3rd level (3 slots):** fireball
- **4th level (1 slot):** wall of fire

ACTIONS:

Forge Staff. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 8 (1d8 + 5) bludgeoning damage plus 7 (2d6) fire damage.

REACTIONS:

Flame Reprisal. When this dwarf succeeds on a saving throw against a spell that deals damage, the caster takes 10 (3d6) fire damage.

- Begins with wall-based battlefield division.
- Focuses fireball-level pressure on clustered targets.
- Uses movement-reduction effects to trap enemies in fire zones.
- Avoids melee unless protected.



DARK DWARF IRON ENFORCER

Medium humanoid (dwarf), any lawful

Armor Class 16 (scale mail, shield)

Hit Points 84 (13d8 + 26)

Speed 25 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
18 (+4)	10 (+0)	15 (+2)	10 (+0)	12 (+1)	14 (+2)

Saving Throws Str +6, Con +4

Skills Athletics +6, Intimidation +4, Perception +3

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 13

Languages Common, Dwarvish

Challenge 1/2 (100 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +2

Stoneborn Discipline. This dwarf has advantage on saving throws against being frightened while within 5 feet of an allied Dark Dwarf.

Authority of Iron. Allied Dark Dwarves within 10 feet of this dwarf have advantage on saving throws against being charmed.

Crushing Presence. When this dwarf reduces a creature to 0 hit points, each enemy creature within 10 feet must succeed on a DC 12 Wisdom saving throw or be frightened of this dwarf until the end of its next turn.

Shield Interlock. While this dwarf is within 5 feet of an allied Dark Dwarf wielding a shield, both gain +1 AC.

ACTIONS:

Multiattack. This dwarf makes two mace attacks.

Iron Mace. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 9 (1d8 + 4) bludgeoning damage.

Subdue (Recharge 5–6). This dwarf attempts to overpower a creature within 5 feet. The target must succeed on a DC 14 Strength saving throw or be knocked prone and restrained until the end of its next turn.

REACTIONS:

Punish Weakness. When a creature within 5 feet of this dwarf fails a saving throw, this dwarf can make one melee attack against that creature.

- Targets weaker or wounded enemies to trigger fear effects.
- Maintains internal discipline during combat.
- Punishes failed saves and broken morale.
- Operates as battlefield intimidation support.



COMPATIBLE CONTENT

Ice Dwarves can be found at the [Winter Wall](#), in a [Winter Tavern](#), or in the arctic [Wilderness Maps](#).

Dark Dwarves can be found in the [Dark Dwarf Tavern](#), or the humanoid section of a [Dungeon Crawl](#).

Volcanic Dwarves can be found volcanic [Wilderness Maps](#).

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